reductions of nuclear weapons by creating a feeling of confidence that national security could be preserved without them.

Of course, as I have said before, I recognize that adding defensive systems to an arsenal replete with weapons with a disarming first strike capability could under some conditions be destabilizing. That is why we are proposing that both sides concentrate first on reducing those weapons which can deliver a disarming first strike. Certainly, if neither of our countries has forces suitable for a first strike, neither need fear that defenses against ballistic missiles would make a first strike strategy possible.

I also do not understand your statement that what you call "space-strike weapons" are "all-purpose" weapons. As I understand it, the sort of directed energy and kinetic devices both our countries are investigating in the context of ballistic missile defenses are potentially most effective against point targets moving at high velocity in space. They would be ill suited for mass destruction on earth. If one were planning to strike earth targets from space, it does not seem rational to resort to such expensive and exotic techniques; the destructiveness can never approach that of the nuclear weapons in our hands today. Nuclear weapons are the real problem.

Mr. General Secretary, in the spirit of candor which is essential to effective communication, I want to add another point: you speak often of space-strike weapons and your representatives have defined these as weapons which can strike targets in space from earth and its atmosphere and weapons in space that can strike targets in space or on earth.

What country has such weapons? The answer is only one: the Soviet Union. Your ABM system deployed